

FC-1

District Schedule

1 INTENT AND OVERVIEW

1.1 Intent

The intent of this schedule is to permit and encourage the development of a high-density mixed commercial use neighbourhood, including some dwelling and compatible industrial uses. For commercial development, a variety of small-scale retail and service uses are encouraged. Larger, more regional-oriented office and retail commercial uses are limited in size for individual sites.

The retention and upgrading of existing multi-unit residential buildings and the development of new residential units on upper floors of commercial buildings are encouraged. Similarly, the development of new hotels is encouraged, provided that these do not result in the conversion of existing residential units. New residential and hotel development will occur mostly to the west of Main Street, oriented to False Creek and the waterfront park system. Special design measures, however, will be necessary to mitigate the air and noise pollution problems, particularly adjacent to some existing industries and major traffic streets.

Without limitation, applicable Council policies and guidelines for consideration include the [Design and Development Guidelines](#).

1.2 Overview

The table below provides an overview of outright and conditional approval uses in the FC-1 district, categorized by the minimum site area required, where applicable. Applicable density, form and placement regulations in section 3 of this schedule are cross-referenced in the third column.

Minimum Site Area	Use	Density, Form and Placement Regulations
--	All uses in section 2.1 of this schedule	3.1

2 USE REGULATIONS

2.1 Outright and Conditional Approval Uses

All outright and conditional approval uses are subject to all other provisions of this by-law, including [Section 2](#), [Section 10](#) and [Section 11](#), and compliance with the regulations of this schedule including section [2.2](#).

The uses identified in the table below as outright approval uses are permitted in this district and will be issued a permit.

The uses identified in the table below as conditional approval uses may be approved in this district by the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board, with or without conditions, if the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers:

- (a) the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines; and
- (b) the submission of any advisory group, property owner or tenant.

Uses are listed under their general land use category. Applicable use-specific regulations in section [2.2](#) of this schedule are cross-referenced in the third column. Cross-references to applicable use-specific regulations are provided for information purposes only and do not form part of this by-law.

Use	Approval	Use-Specific Regulations
Cultural and Recreational Uses		
Arcade	Conditional	2.2.1
Artist Studio	Conditional	2.2.1
Arts and Culture Event	Outright	2.2.1
Billiard Hall	Conditional	2.2.1
Bingo Hall	Conditional	2.2.1
Bowling Alley	Outright	2.2.1
Casino - Class 1	Conditional	2.2.1
Club	Conditional	2.2.1
Community Centre or Neighbourhood House	Outright	2.2.1
Fitness Centre	Outright	2.2.1
Hall	Outright	2.2.1
Library	Outright	2.2.1
Museum or Archives	Conditional	2.2.1
Park or Playground	Conditional	
Rink	Outright	2.2.1
Swimming Pool	Outright	2.2.1
Theatre	Outright	2.2.1
Zoo or Botanical Garden	Conditional	2.2.1
Dwelling Uses		

Use	Approval	Use-Specific Regulations
Mixed-Use Residential Building	Conditional	2.2.2 , 2.2.3 , 2.2.5 , 2.2.6
Micro Dwelling	Conditional	2.2.2
Multiple Dwelling	Conditional	2.2.2 , 2.2.3 , 2.2.4 , 2.2.5
Multiple Dwelling, lawfully existing as of February 3, 2026	Outright	2.2.2 , 2.2.3
Residential Unit associated with and forming an integral part of an Artist Studio	Conditional	2.2.2
Rooming House	Conditional	2.2.2 , 2.2.3 , 2.2.6
Seniors Supportive or Independent Living Housing	Conditional	2.2.2
Institutional Uses		
Ambulance Station	Conditional	2.2.1
Child Day Care Facility	Conditional	2.2.1
Church	Conditional	2.2.1
Community Care or Assisted Living Facility - Class B	Conditional	2.2.1
Detoxification Centre	Conditional	2.2.1
Group Residence	Conditional	2.2.1
Public Authority Use	Conditional	2.2.1
School - Elementary or Secondary	Conditional	2.2.1
School - University or College	Outright	2.2.1
Social Service Centre	Conditional	2.2.1
Manufacturing Uses		
Clothing Manufacturing	Conditional	2.2.1
Jewellery Manufacturing	Conditional	2.2.1
Miscellaneous Products Manufacturing - Class B	Conditional	2.2.1
Printing and Publishing	Conditional	2.2.1
Office Uses		
Financial Institution	Outright	2.2.1
General Office	Outright	2.2.1
Health Care Office	Conditional	2.2.1
Health Enhancement Centre	Conditional	2.2.1
Parking Uses		
Parking Uses	Conditional	

Use	Approval	Use-Specific Regulations
Retail Uses		
Cannabis Store	Conditional	2.2.1
Farmers' Market	Conditional	2.2.8
Furniture or Appliance Store	Outright	2.2.1
Gasoline Station - Full Serve	Conditional	
Gasoline Station - Split Island	Conditional	
Grocery or Drug Store	Outright	2.2.1
Grocery Store with Liquor Store	Conditional	2.2.1
Liquor Store	Conditional	2.2.1
Pawnshop	Conditional	2.2.1
Public Bike Share	Conditional	
Retail Store	Outright	2.2.1
Secondhand Store	Conditional	2.2.1
Shared E-Scooter System	Conditional	
Small-Scale Pharmacy	Conditional	2.2.1
Vehicle Dealer	Conditional	
Service Uses		
Animal Clinic or Shelter	Conditional	2.2.1
Animal Services	Conditional	2.2.1
Auction Hall	Outright	2.2.1
Barber Shop or Beauty Salon	Outright	2.2.1
Beauty and Wellness Centre	Outright	2.2.1
Bed and Breakfast Accommodation	Conditional	2.2.1
Cabaret	Conditional	2.2.1
Catering Establishment	Outright	2.2.1
Drive-Through Service	Conditional	
Funeral Home	Conditional	2.2.1
Hotel	Conditional	2.2.1, 2.2.2
Laboratory	Conditional	2.2.1
Laundromat or Dry Cleaning Establishment	Outright	2.2.1
Motor Vehicle Repair Shop	Conditional	2.2.1
Motor Vehicle Wash	Conditional	2.2.1
Neighbourhood Public House	Conditional	
Photofinishing or Photography Laboratory	Conditional	2.2.1

Use	Approval	Use-Specific Regulations
Photofinishing or Photography Studio	Outright	2.2.1
Print Shop	Outright	2.2.1
Production or Rehearsal Studio	Conditional	2.2.1
Repair Shop - Class A	Conditional	2.2.1
Repair Shop - Class B	Outright	2.2.1
Restaurant - Class 1	Outright	
Restaurant - Class 2	Conditional	2.2.1
Restaurant - Drive-In	Conditional	
School - Arts or Self-Improvement	Outright	2.2.1
School - Business	Outright	2.2.1
School - Vocational or Trade	Outright	2.2.1
Short Term Rental Accommodation	Conditional	2.2.1
Sign Painting Shop	Outright	2.2.1
Wedding Chapel	Conditional	2.2.1
Transportation and Storage Uses		
Mini-Storage Warehouse	Conditional	2.2.1
Railway Station or Rail Yard	Conditional	2.2.1
Storage Warehouse	Conditional	2.2.1
Taxicab or Limousine Station	Conditional	2.2.1
Utility and Communication Uses		
Public Utility	Conditional	2.2.1
Radiocommunication Station	Conditional	2.2.1
Recycling Depot	Conditional	2.2.1
Wholesale Uses		
Lumber and Building Materials Establishment	Conditional	
Wholesaling - Class A	Conditional	2.2.1
Wholesaling - Class B	Conditional	2.2.1
uncategorized		
Accessory Buildings, customarily ancillary to any use listed in this section 2.1	Outright	2.2.1, 2.2.9
Accessory Uses, customarily ancillary to any outright approval use listed in this section 2.1	Outright	2.2.1
Accessory Uses, customarily ancillary to any use listed in this section 2.1 and not permitted as an outright use	Conditional	2.2.1

Use	Approval	Use-Specific Regulations
Any other use that is not specifically listed and defined as a use in Section 2 of this by-law	Conditional	2.2.1 , 2.2.10
Deposition or extraction of material, which alters the configuration of the land	Conditional	

2.2 Use-Specific Regulations

- 2.2.1 All outright approval uses listed in section [2.1](#) of this schedule, and all conditional approval uses listed in section [2.1](#) of this schedule that are commercial uses, must be carried on wholly within a completely enclosed building, other than the following:
- (a) arts and culture event;
 - (b) display of flowers and vegetables;
 - (c) drive-through service;
 - (d) farmers' market;
 - (e) gasoline station - full serve;
 - (f) gasoline station - split island;
 - (g) hydrotherapy, thermal therapy, or both;
 - (h) lumber and building material establishment;
 - (i) neighbourhood public house;
 - (j) outdoor eating area in combination with a cabaret, club, grocery or drug store, restaurant - class 2, or retail store, subject to any conditions that the Director of Planning considers necessary, having regard to the area and location of the eating area with respect to adjoining sites, the hours of operation and the intent of this schedule;
 - (k) parking and loading facilities;
 - (l) public bike share;
 - (m) restaurant - class 1;
 - (n) restaurant - drive-in;
 - (o) shared e-scooter system;
 - (p) taxicab or limousine station; and
 - (q) vehicle dealer,

except that the Director of Planning may vary this regulation to permit the outdoor display of retail goods and the Director of Planning may impose any conditions that the Director of Planning considers necessary,

having regard to the types of merchandise, the area and location of the display with respect to adjoining sites, the hours of operation and the intent of this schedule.

- 2.2.2 The conversion or upgrading of existing dwelling uses to hotels or other uses is subject to all applicable Council policies and guidelines regarding the protection of existing tenants.
- 2.2.3 Mixed-use residential building, multiple dwelling, multiple dwelling, lawfully existing as of February 3, 2026 and rooming house may be permitted if the Director of Planning considers the site suitable for dwelling use.
- 2.2.4 Multiple dwelling may be permitted only in the area south of National Avenue.
- 2.2.5 For multiple dwelling or mixed-used residential building, at least 25% of the total number of dwelling units must have 2 or more bedrooms, except that the Director of Planning may vary this regulation if the Director of Planning considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable policies and guidelines.
- 2.2.6 In the area north of National Avenue, no portion of the first storey of a mixed-use residential building, to a depth of 10.7 m from the front wall of the building and extending across its full width, may be used for residential purposes except for entrances to the residential portion.
- 2.2.7 Any of the non-dwelling uses listed in section 2.1 of this schedule are permitted in a mixed-use residential building.
- 2.2.8 Farmers' market may be permitted if the Director of Planning considers the appropriateness of the use with respect to compatibility with nearby sites, parking, traffic, noise, hours of operation, size of facility and pedestrian amenity.
- 2.2.9 Accessory buildings customarily ancillary to any use listed in section 2.1 of this schedule are permitted as an outright approval use if:
 - (a) no accessory building exceeds 3.7 m in height measured to:
 - (i) the highest point of a flat roof,
 - (ii) the deck line of a mansard roof, or
 - (iii) the mean height between the eaves and the ridge of a gable, hip or gambrel roof,
 provided that no portion of an accessory building exceeds 4.6 m in building height; and
 - (b) the total floor area of all accessory buildings, measured to the extreme outer limits of the building, does not exceed 10% of the total site area.
- 2.2.10 Any other use that is not specifically listed and defined as a use in Section 2 of this by-law may be permitted if the Director of Planning considers the use to be comparable in nature to the uses listed in this schedule, having regard to the intent of this schedule.

3 DENSITY, FORM AND PLACEMENT REGULATIONS

This section contains density, form and placement regulations organized by use.

3.1 All Uses

All uses in this district are subject to the following regulations.

3.1.1 Density and Floor Area

3.1.1.1 Developments requiring social housing are subject to [Schedule J: Affordable Housing Schedule](#).

3.1.1.2 The maximum floor space ratio is 5.00, subject to the following allocations:

- (a) the maximum floor space ratio is 3.00 for dwelling uses;
- (b) the maximum floor space ratio is 4.00 for hotel;
- (c) the maximum floor space ratio is 1.50 for office uses or detoxification centre;
- (d) the maximum floor space ratio is 1.00 for retail or service uses, other than hotel; and
- (e) the maximum floor space ratio is 3.00 for all other non-dwelling uses combined, or 4.00 where a development includes hotel with a floor space ratio of at least 1.00.

3.1.1.3 Despite section [3.1.1.2](#) above, the Director of Planning or the Development Permit Board may vary the permitted floor space ratio to a maximum of 11.00 if:

- (a) a minimum of 50% of the total floor area is developed as residential floor area;
- (b) the form of tenure is secured as residential rental tenure for 100% of the residential floor area;
- (c) a minimum of 20% of the residential units are developed as social housing; and
- (d) the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

3.1.1.4 For mixed-use residential building in the area north of National Avenue, the minimum floor space ratio for non-dwelling uses on the first storey facing the street is 0.35.

3.1.1.5 Despite the provisions of section [3.1.1.2](#) and [3.1.1.3](#) above, the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may increase the permitted floor space ratio by a maximum of 10% for the conservation of heritage property if:

- (a) Council first approves a heritage designation by-law;

- (b) the development includes substantial retention and conservation of the existing structure and its character-defining elements; and
- (c) the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

3.1.2 Building Form and Placement

Regulations	FC-1
3.1.2.1 Maximum unit frontage for uses on the ground level	15.3 m
3.1.2.2 Minimum site frontage for a building with a floor space ratio greater than 5.50	15.0 m
3.1.2.3 Maximum site frontage	45.7 m
3.1.2.4 Maximum building height	69.2 m
3.1.2.5 Minimum front setback for sites:	
(a) on the west side of Main Street, south of Terminal Avenue	3.0 m
(b) on the south side of Terminal Avenue, from Main Street to Quebec Street	6.0 m

Site Frontage

- 3.1.2.6 Despite section [3.1.2.3](#), the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may increase the maximum site frontage if the Director of Planning or the Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.
- 3.1.2.7 Despite section [3.1.2.2](#) above, the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may decrease the minimum site frontage if:
 - (a) the floor space ratio does not exceed 8.50;
 - (b) 100% of the residential units are developed as social housing; and
 - (c) the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

Building Height

- 3.1.2.8 Despite section [3.1.2.4](#), the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may increase the maximum building height to a height not exceeding 100.0 m if the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers all applicable Council policies and guidelines and the height, bulk, location, and overall design of

the building and its impact on the site and on surrounding buildings in terms of liveability, protected public views, and public spaces such as parks, playgrounds, and plazas.

4 GENERAL REGULATIONS

All uses in this district are subject to the following regulations.

4.1 Computation of Floor Area

4.1.1 Computation of floor area must include:

- (a) all floors, including earthen floor, measured to the extreme outer limits of the building, including accessory buildings; and
- (b) stairways, fire escapes, elevator shafts and other features that the Director of Planning considers similar to the foregoing, measured by their gross cross-sectional areas and included in the measurements for each floor at which they are located.

4.1.2 Computation of floor area must exclude:

- (a) balconies and decks, and any other appurtenances that the Director of Planning considers similar to the foregoing, provided that:
 - (i) the total area of these exclusions does not exceed 12% of the permitted floor area, and
 - (ii) the balconies must not be enclosed for the life of the building;
- (b) patios and roof decks;
- (c) entries, porches and verandahs, if:
 - (i) open or protected by guards that do not exceed the required minimum height, and
 - (ii) the total area of these exclusions, when combined with the balcony and deck exclusions under section 4.1.2(a) above, does not exceed 16% of the permitted floor area;
- (d) child day care facilities to a maximum floor area of 10% of the total permitted floor area;
- (e) floors or portions of floors used for:
 - (i) off-street parking and loading, those floors or portions thereof which are located at or below base surface, provided that the maximum exclusion for a parking space does not exceed 7.3 m in length,
 - (ii) bicycle storage,
 - (iii) heating and mechanical equipment, or
 - (iv) uses that the Director of Planning considers similar to the foregoing;
- (f) areas of undeveloped floors that are located:
 - (i) above the highest storey or partial storey and to which there is no permanent means of access other than a hatch, or

- (ii) adjacent to a storey or partial storey with a ceiling height of less than 1.2 m;
- (g) floors located at or below finished grade with a ceiling height of less than 1.2 m;
- (h) all residential storage area, except that if storage area above base surface exceeds 3.7 m² per dwelling unit, there will be no exclusion for any of the storage area above the base surface for that unit; and
- (i) common amenity areas to a maximum of 10% of the total permitted floor area.

4.1.3 The Director of Planning may permit the following to be excluded from the computation of floor area:

- (a) enclosed residential balconies, if the Director of Planning considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines and approves the design of any balcony enclosure, except that:
 - (i) the total area of all open and enclosed balcony or deck exclusions does not exceed 8% of the permitted residential floor area, and
 - (ii) no more than 50% of the excluded balcony floor area may be enclosed; and
- (b) interior public space, including atria and other similar spaces, if:
 - (i) the total excluded area does not exceed the lesser of 10% of the permitted floor area or 600 m²,
 - (ii) the excluded area is secured by covenant and right of way in favour of the City that set out public access and use, and
 - (iii) the Director of Planning considers the intent of this schedule all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

5 RELAXATIONS

5.1 The Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may relax the maximum unit frontage regulation in section 3.1.2.1 of this schedule if:

- (a) a public pedestrian amenity area such as a courtyard or resting area is provided, or where public pedestrian interest is otherwise maintained; and
- (b) the Director of Planning considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

5.2 The Director of Planning or Development Permit Board may relax:

- (a) the regulation in section 2.2.4 above to permit multiple dwelling in the area north of National Avenue; and
- (b) the non-dwelling use regulations in sections 2.2.6 and 3.1.1.4, the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

if 100% of the residential floor area is developed as social housing and the Director of Planning or Development Permit Board considers the intent of this schedule and all applicable Council policies and guidelines.

- 5.3 Where a need for any public, social, cultural or recreational facility has been demonstrated to the satisfaction of the Development Permit Board, the Development Permit Board may relax the maximum floor space ratio or density for any 1 building that includes 1 or more of such facilities, and may require that any such facility be preserved in the public domain by way of a registered agreement and operated by the City or its delegates and in determining the amount of the increase in floor area or density that may be permitted, the Development Permit Board must consider:
- (a) the construction cost of the facility;
 - (b) any costs to the developer of continuing maintenance required for the facility;
 - (c) the rental value of the increased floor area; and
 - (d) the value of any authorized relaxation of other restrictions.